

YPB 2026 Application — Strategy & NotebookLM Setup

For: Dakol | SyncMaster Founder

Programme: Young Professionals Bootcamp (YPB) 2026

Track: Entrepreneurship + Creative Industry

Grant pool: Up to ₦150 Million available

Part 1: How to Position for YPB

What YPB Is Actually Selecting For

YPB is not a pitch competition. It is a leadership + enterprise programme. Selection criteria weight:

- **Problem-solver mindset** — passionate about solving real problems in Nigeria
- **Existing traction or venture** — especially for the grant component
- **Creative industry credibility** — film, music, design, creative economy
- **Ambition anchored in Nigeria** — not “I want to move abroad” energy

How SyncMaster Maps to YPB’s Mission

YPB Priority	SyncMaster Angle
Solve Nigerian problems	Nigerian composers are invisible in a global industry that profits from African sound
Creative industry	Music licensing + Nollywood ecosystem — directly in their sweet spot
Innovation	AI-assisted curation + rights clarity infrastructure — no one is doing this in Nigeria
Economic transformation	Nigerian creators capturing sync revenue they’re currently missing
Grant-eligible	

venture	Existing product, real target market, clear revenue model
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The YPB Speakers Signal What They Respect

Past speakers include Bolanle Austen-Peters (BAP/Terrakulture), Kemi Adetiba (film director), Gaise Baba (music), Ojoma Ochai (CCHUB). This is a panel that understands the creative economy deeply. Frame SyncMaster in creative economy + infrastructure terms, not pure tech startup terms.

Part 2: Application Narrative Framework

The Core Story (use across written application + video)

Hook: "Nigerian music is everywhere. Nigerian composers are nowhere in the revenue conversation."

Problem: Nollywood is the world's second-largest film industry. Afrobeats is a global phenomenon. But Nigerian composers — the people scoring films, creating sonic identities — have no professional channel to licensing deals. The sync industry runs on rights clarity and curation. Nobody has built that infrastructure for African music.

Solution: SyncMaster is a curated sync licensing marketplace. We vet African composers, structure their rights, and match them to briefs from producers and brands who need original music. Think of it as a managed A&R service for the African creative economy.

Traction: Built a full web platform (Next.js, Supabase, AI layer). Three user roles: admin, producer, composer. The brief-to-placement workflow is live. Building composer supply and brief demand in parallel.

Why me: UI/UX + B2B product background. Built this solo using AI-assisted development. Living the problem — I understand both the tech infrastructure and the creative industry context.

Ask (for grant): Capital to accelerate composer onboarding, brief sourcing, and the first 10 placements. Every placement generates data that makes the matching engine smarter.

Part 3: Video Submission Guide

Structure (keep to 60–90 seconds)

0–10s: Hook Start with the tension, not with yourself.

"Nigerian music is played in boardrooms from Lagos to Los Angeles. But the composers writing that music have never seen a sync licensing deal."

10–30s: Who you are + what you're building

"I'm [Name], founder of SyncMaster. We're building the infrastructure layer between African composers and the global sync licensing market. A curated brief marketplace with rights clarity built in."

30–50s: What you've built + why it works

"We've built the platform. Composer vetting, structured brief system, placement tracking. The model: producers submit briefs, we match 5 vetted composers, they get placement opportunities they couldn't access alone."

50–70s: Why YPB

"I'm applying to YPB because building in Nigeria means navigating creative economy challenges that no Silicon Valley playbook covers. I need mentorship from people who've built creative businesses here, and access to the network that can help me source those first 10 briefs."

70–90s: Close

"SyncMaster is Nigerian creative infrastructure. The goal is simple: the next Nollywood score that lands a Netflix deal — I want SyncMaster to have made that possible."

Video Production Tips

- Film in a quiet, well-lit space. Natural light preferred.
- Business casual — aligned with YPB's dress code signal.
- Speak to camera, not script. Use bullet points as prompts, not full lines.
- Show product on screen if you can (screen share section showing the dashboard briefly).
- Keep energy direct and grounded — not sales-pitch hyped.

Part 4: NotebookLM Setup Guide

Why NotebookLM for This Application

NotebookLM uses your uploaded sources to give grounded, citation-backed answers. When you ask “How should I answer the question about market opportunity?”, it pulls directly from your SyncMaster context — not from generic internet data.

Sources to Upload (in order of priority)

File	Why
<code>SyncMaster_CaseStudy.md</code>	Core product and founder context
<code>SyncMaster_YPB_ApplicationStrategy.md</code> (this doc)	Application narrative framework
YPB website copy (paste as plain text note)	Programme context for calibrating answers
Any pitch deck or one-pager you have	Visual narrative alignment

How to Add the SyncMaster Case Study as a Source

1. Open NotebookLM → Create new notebook → Name it “YPB 2026 Application”
2. Click “Add Source” → Upload → Select `SyncMaster_CaseStudy.md`
3. Add this file too → `SyncMaster_YPB_ApplicationStrategy.md`
4. Add a “Pasted text” source with the YPB website content (copy-paste their About + FAQ section)
5. Wait for processing (usually 30 seconds)

Queries to Run in NotebookLM After Setup

For written application:

- “Help me write a 150-word answer to: Describe the problem you are solving and why it matters in Nigeria”
- “What are the strongest signals of traction I can reference from my SyncMaster context?”
- “How does SyncMaster qualify for the grant component based on the eligibility criteria?”

For video prep:

- “Give me 5 different hook lines I could open my video with, based on my product

context"

- "What would a YPB creative industry speaker like Bolanle Austen-Peters find most compelling about SyncMaster?"
- "What objections might a selection panel raise, and how should I address them?"

For grant pitch:

- "Draft a concise grant use-of-funds breakdown for SyncMaster's first 10 placements milestone"
 - "What is the economic case for SyncMaster's impact on Nigeria's creative economy?"
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Part 5: Application Checklist

- Upload SyncMaster_CaseStudy.md to NotebookLM
 - Upload this strategy doc to NotebookLM
 - Paste YPB website content as a source in NotebookLM
 - Run 3–5 calibration queries to verify the notebook understands your context
 - Draft written application answers using NotebookLM as research assistant
 - Record video (use the 90-second framework above)
 - Review Tally application form: <https://tally.so/r/xXNg6G>
 - Submit before deadline (June 2026 bootcamp — check exact date)
 - Email any questions to: platformypbteam@gmail.com
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This document is a strategic brief, not a script. Use it to direct NotebookLM — not to read from it verbatim.